

## Adverbial phrases

Like adverbs, adverbial phrases describe verbs, adjectives, and other adverbs. They answer questions such as: How? When? Why? Where? How often?

**angrily across the stage**

This is an adverbial phrase because it is describing how (“angrily”) and where (“across the stage”) the drummer strode.

**behind their instruments**

This is an adverbial phrase because it is describing where the members of the band hid.

## GLOSSARY

**Adjective phrase** A group of words that describe a noun or pronoun.

**Adverbial phrase** A group of words such as “in July of last year” that perform the same role as an adverb and answer questions such as: How? When? Why? Where? How often?

**Noun phrase** Several words that, grouped together, perform the same function as a noun.

**Prepositional phrase** A preposition such as *in* or *on* followed by a noun or pronoun that together act as an adjective (describing a noun) or an adverb (describing a verb) in a sentence.

**strode angrily across the stage.**  
**hid behind their instruments.**

## Prepositional phrases

Prepositional phrases are the most common type of phrase, but they always act as either adjectives or adverbs in a sentence, modifying nouns or verbs. They are therefore contained within—or make up—adjective or adverbial phrases. A prepositional phrase is made up of a preposition, along with the noun or noun phrase that follows it.

**behind their instruments**

preposition

This prepositional phrase is acting as an adverb, because it is modifying the verb *hid*.

**across the stage**

preposition

This prepositional phrase is also acting as an adverb, because it is modifying the verb *strode*.

**of the band**

preposition

This prepositional phrase is acting as an adjective, because it is describing the noun *members*.